

Equity Market Review

Dollar trade turning

Falling USD has been a key driver of equity market dispersion ytd. But there are emerging supports to the dollar, while the French political crisis and concerns about German fiscal stimulus are weighing on the euro. A softening eurUSD may help EU exporters (BCEUEUX) catch-up, and earnings.

Weekly market commentary

Dollar trade turning. The US dollar has been one of the main casualties of the Trump trade ytd. Sell America concerns caused by Trumponomics have seen the DXY falling c.12% from January highs. The administration's occasional preference for a weaker dollar, combined with tariff uncertainty and a resurgent German recovery narrative, has prompted investors to diversify away from the greenback. While the dollar has shown signs of stabilisation since summer, its recovery remains muted relative to the strength in US equities and Treasuries. Indeed, dollar positioning continues to be extremely short, as investors use the dollar as a vehicle to express their concerns about Fed independence, while gold has surged. However, some supports to the dollar are emerging: SCOTUS has allowed Lisa Cook to be part of the FOMC until January; the lack of data releases due to the government shutdown has delayed narratives to drive the dollar; renewed French political risks, concerns about execution of the fiscal stimulus in Germany and softening data surprises have capped the euro, which had arguably been the main beneficiary of dollar weakness. In fact, the euro this week has broken below the key 100d MA technical levels which could potentially trigger further selling by systematic investors. Also, in Japan, Takaichi's surprise election victory has led to a bearish repricing of yen expectations, with prospects for fiscal easing and a slower BoJ hiking path thus adding to upside pressure on the dollar (see [Yen rates and FX outlook on Takaichi victory](#), 6 Oct). Indeed, outside of the Fed independence concerns which is a non-trivial tail risk, potentially better US growth into next year on easing financial conditions and fiscal impulse could provide more dollar stability according to our FX strategists (see [Is the dollar bottoming out?](#) 23 Sep) while 'Buy America' makes a comeback as the AI theme drives further inflows into the US. So the recent turnaround in the dollar could potentially have legs, in our view. More importantly, the recent dollar appreciation hasn't been a headwind to risk assets yet, as it reflects only a mild re-adjustment in growth/policy expectations. However, if the dollar were to strengthen further because of a troubled macro backdrop in the EU/RoW and its perceived characteristics as a 'safe haven', it might trigger a more defensive price action in risk assets.

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Our weekly pack contains key charts on performance valuation and technicals

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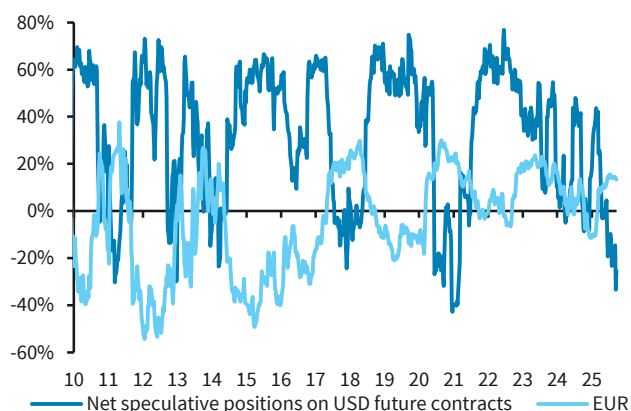
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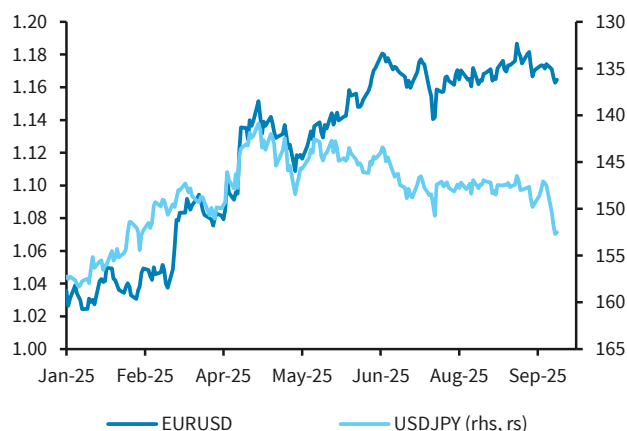
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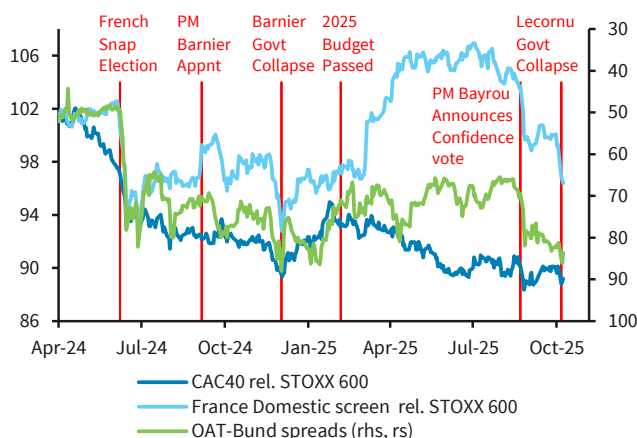
FIGURE 1. CFTC dollar positioning remains very short while Euro is a net long...

Note: Latest data as of 23 Sep
 Source: CFTC, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

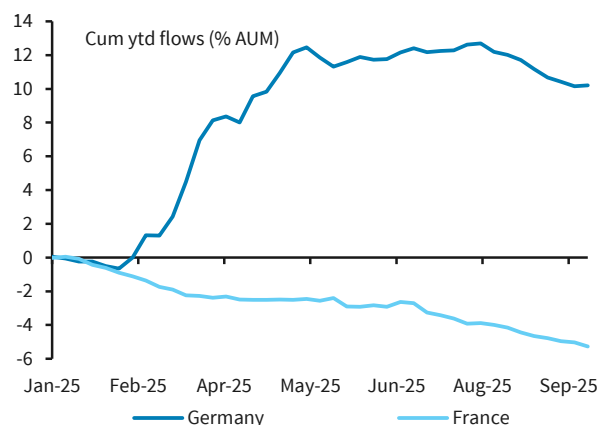
FIGURE 2. ...but EUR and JPY are starting to weaken vs. USD

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

France - snap election risk reduced, but still in the fog. EURUSD largely ignored French political risk since President Macron dissolved the national assembly in June 2024, which resulted in a hung parliament. However, renewed uncertainty after the recently appointed PM Lecornu resigned on Monday likely added some downward pressure to the euro. Much has happened since, as the outgoing PM, after meeting the main parties, said on Wednesday night that there was ground for an agreement on a budget at the assembly, as most PMs are against a dissolution, and President Macron should be able to nominate a new PM, possibly a technocrat, by Friday. So the risk of a snap election - the primary concern for markets - appears to have eased for now. OAT-Bund spreads have narrowed slightly, while French equities have staged a modest rebound. Lecornu also said that a budget draft could be presented at the assembly on Monday, which gives 70 days for parliament debate, and is within the deadline for a vote by end of December. So a small relief, yet, the path forward won't be easy, in our view, given the inability of the three main blocks to compromise in recent months. The left is asking for the pension reform to be repealed, which is a red line for the right. Meanwhile, the far right RN party has vowed to block any incoming administration. Macron's authority appears significantly weakened, with 18 months still to run before the presidential election in April 2027. So while not the dominant driver, political dysfunction in France, along with concerns about fiscal stimulus execution in Germany, may limit any meaningful euro upside for now.

FIGURE 3. Risk premia remain elevated across French bonds and equities

Source: Bloomberg, LSEG Data & Analytics, Barclays Research

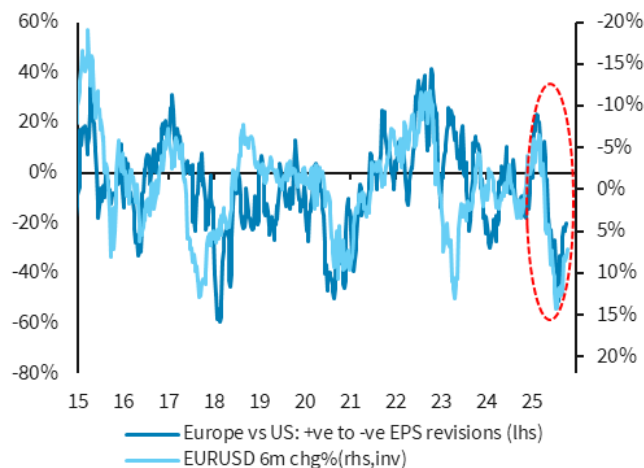
FIGURE 4. Equity flows are stalling in Germany and remain negative in France

Source: EPFR, Barclays Research

Peaking euro eases the pressure on EU exporters and earnings. EU equities struggled to breakout from their range of the past 6 months, partly because the strong euro weighed on exporters and led to negative EPS revisions. However, amid the recent stabilisation in the euro, the SXXP finally started to melt up. Yet, with our EU exporters basket (BCEUEUX) still down c.16% relative to domestics (BCEUEDOM) ytd, we believe that the catch-up trade for exporters could have legs, especially if the recent rebound in the dollar holds. More broadly, we are seeing the headwinds to EU earnings easing, as eurUSD has stabilised since the start of the summer. Notably, 2025 EPS growth expectations for our exporters basket has been cut from 10% to -2% since the start of the year, implying that much of the bad news appears to be priced in on the earnings side. From a sector allocation perspective, we have gradually shifted from a domestic bias in our portfolio, to a more barbell approach between domestics and exporters. While we remain OW Banks and A&D, we now also favour exposure to sectors like Luxury, Tech, and Capital Goods, which stand to benefit as FX and tariff pressures ease and as US/China macro conditions become less bad. Additionally, we have added to Healthcare this week, which is a strong dollar earner and has de-rated heavily, but should find more support as drug pricing concerns abate (see [Liquidity glut & AI boom](#), 9 Oct).

FIGURE 5. EU exporters basket (BCEUEUX) has underperformed in line with the rising eurUSD ytd

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

FIGURE 6. Europe vs US EPS revisions starting to stabilise with EURUSD

Source: IBES, LSEG Data & Analytics, Barclays Research

The Week Ahead

Next week, the US release calendar could get disrupted due to the government shutdown - US CPI m/m for Sep (15 Oct): BBG Cons - 0.4% (similar to Aug); US retail sales for Sep (16 Oct): BBG Cons - 0.4% (vs. 0.6% previously); US housing starts for Sep (17 Oct); Zew survey expectations for Oct (14 Oct); EU CPI for Sep (17 Oct).

FIGURE 7. Key events/data releases next week

Region	Date	Events
US	15-Oct	CPI; Empire mfg; Avg hourly earnings
	16-Oct	Retail sales; PPI; Philly Fed business outlook; NAHB housing market index
	17-Oct	Housing starts; Building permits; Trade data; Industrial production Capacity utilization; Total net TIC flows
Eurozone	14-Oct	Zew survey expectations
	15-Oct	Industrial production
	17-Oct	CPI
Germany	14-Oct	CPI; Zew survey data
France	15-Oct	CPI
Italy	15-Oct	General govt debt
	16 pct	CPI; Trade balance
Spain	15-Oct	CPI
UK	14-Oct	ILO unemployment data; Jobless claims; Avg weekly earnings
	16-Oct	Monthly GDP; Industrial production; Trade balance
Japan	14-Oct	Money stock
	15-Oct	Industrial production; Capacity utilization
	16-Oct	Core machine orders; Tertiary industry index; Nationwide dept sales
China	13-Oct	Trade balance
	15-Oct	PPI; CPI
Other events	13-18 Oct	World Bank and IMF Annual meeting

Source: Bloomberg, Secondary sources, Barclays Research

Weekly Flows update

Cash and Credit funds ahead of Equities and Bonds this week

Equities are seeing another strong week of inflows with \$20bn; four consecutive weeks of inflows. This is mainly driven by US, Global funds and EM equities. Europe-ex UK also see healthy inflows this week, while the UK continues to witness redemptions. Japan saw its most outflows this week since Aug'25, after five weeks of inflows.

Globally, all sectors saw inflows this week. Tech remains the sector with the most inflows, while Healthcare gained second spot. Defensive sectors like Utilities, Telcos and Staples remain relative laggards. In Europe, Industrials was the only sector with inflows this week. Healthcare and Financials saw the most outflows this week.

Fixed income funds are now seeing six months of weekly inflows. Flows this week were well spread out across Bonds and Credit funds. In the US, treasuries, along with IG and HY saw strong inflows. In Europe, IG saw strong inflows, while HY and govies saw minor inflows. MM funds are seeing three weeks of inflows totalling \$115bn.

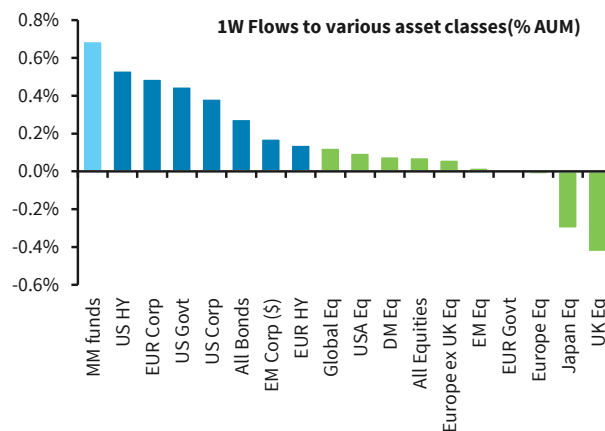
Year-to-date, MM funds flows are inching closer to the \$900bn mark. Fixed income funds (\$593bn) maintain their second position, as Equity flows (\$520bn) narrow the gap with consistent inflows recently.

FIGURE 8. Cross-asset and regional flows snapshot (\$bn)

\$bn	YTD	1m	3m	6m	12m	1W
Equities	520.0	133.9	176.1	278.2	736.1	20.0
DM	480.7	110.7	147.5	249.3	727.5	19.5
Global	178.6	24.1	73.5	148.4	207.6	8.2
USA	238.3	85.2	72.0	76.5	482.9	14.2
Europe	50.4	1.9	2.5	28.4	24.3	-0.3
Europe ex UK	78.5	5.4	10.7	44.3	56.2	1.0
UK	-28.1	-3.6	-8.1	-15.9	-31.9	-1.3
Japan	-10.4	-2.1	-12.5	-18.9	-17.3	-3.0
EM	39.3	23.2	28.6	28.8	8.5	0.5
Active Equity	-169.2	-15.4	-45.3	-87.7	-249.3	-3.6
Passive Equity	689.2	149.4	221.4	365.9	985.4	23.6
MM funds	865.9	110.2	351.8	521.0	1,192.7	72.9
Fixed income	593.0	84.5	281.7	439.4	696.0	25.6
US Govt	74.7	8.5	26.4	28.8	73.0	3.3
US Corp	26.3	4.3	18.7	20.9	31.8	2.3
US HY	28.1	6.1	14.8	28.1	28.9	2.2
EUR Govt	19.3	-0.1	3.1	9.3	23.9	0.0
EUR Corp	48.2	6.8	21.2	39.6	56.9	3.7
EUR HY	7.8	0.2	3.8	8.8	10.5	0.2

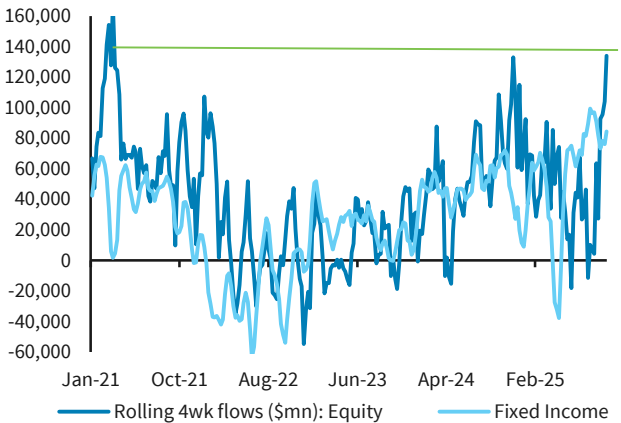
Source: EPFR, Barclays Research

FIGURE 9. Cash, Credit and Bonds well ahead of equities this week



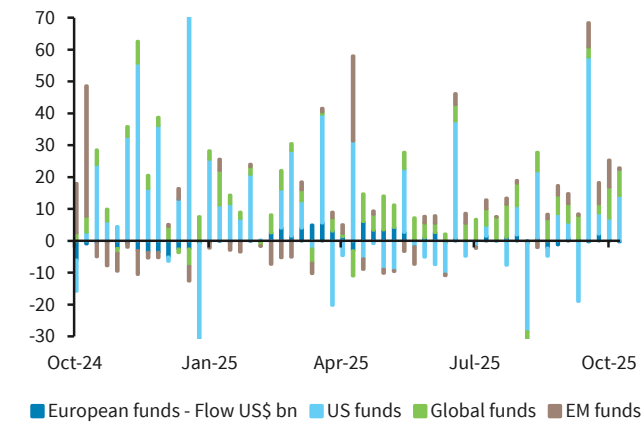
Source: EPFR, Barclays Research

FIGURE 10. Equity flows rolling average is the highest since Mar'21 and well ahead of Fixed income flows...



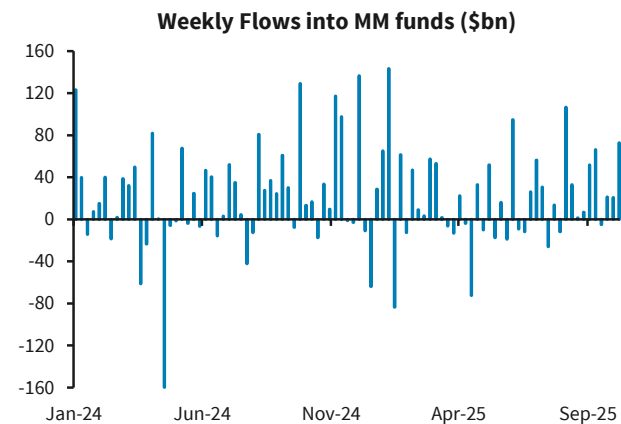
Source: EPFR, Barclays Research

FIGURE 11. ...bulk of it being driven by US and EM funds recently



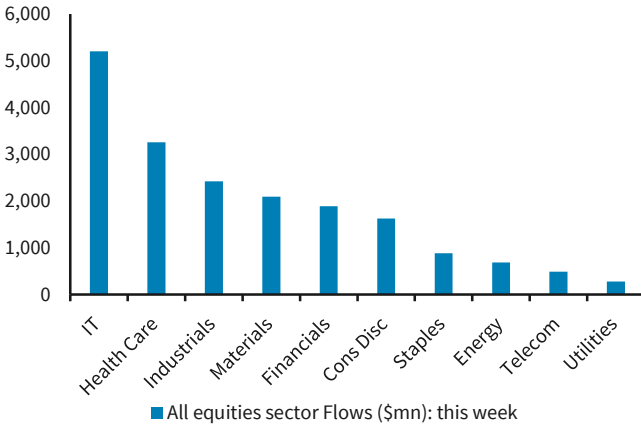
Source: EPFR, Barclays Research

FIGURE 12. MM funds are seeing strong inflows since August, they have received >\$375bn inflows



Source: EPFR, Barclays Research

FIGURE 13. Globally, all sectors saw inflows this week



Source: EPFR, Barclays Research

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